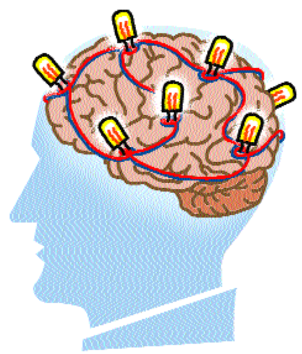
Brainfeed

Linking people's brains together to form a collective intelligence. Humans living beyond 100 years. These can all happen with proper investments in technology, according to a recent report from the US National Science Foundation and the Department of Commerce. The 405-page report argues that a host



of advances can be achieved in the next 20 years alone.

Authorities cast doubt on proposals such as capturing consciousness through computers or linking neurons with nanocircuitry. Our minds may not be able to handle the flood of information resulting from a brain-machine interface, suggests Jeremy Rifkin, author of books on biotechnology and globalisation. Rifkin said society ought to pick and choose carefully among emerging technologies, given potential downsides. "Some of that harm can be irreversible—especially in biotechnology," he said.

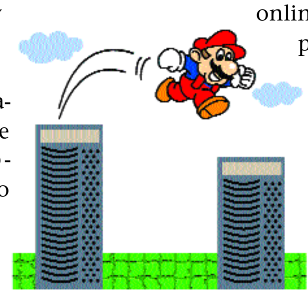
snapshot

US tops Web traffic with 42.65 per cent, China second with 6.63 per cent

Source: WebSideStory Inc

Grid computing for online games

Software development site CollabNet is working with Butterfly.net, an IBM-backed effort to create a supercomputing grid for hosting online games. Butterfly will also use CollabNet's SourceCast Web application to enable game development teams to share source code, manage assets and design games. Butterfly.net is an effort to apply grid-computing, in which computational tasks are spread over multiple networked computers, to the infrastructure challenges of hosting online games. The increasing sophistication of online games, the most popular of which manage thousands of simultaneous players, has made infrastructure a growing concern among developers. Spreading the computing power required across several computers may be the most effective solution available.



Bill's in your PC

An addition to Microsoft's End User Licensing Agreement reads as, "You agree that in order to protect the integrity of content and software protected by digital rights management ('Secure Content'), Microsoft may provide security- related updates to the OS components that will be automatically downloaded onto your computer. These security-related updates may disable your ability to copy and/or play Secure Content and use other software on your computer. If we provide such a security update, we will use reasonable efforts to post notices on a Web site explaining the update." Meaning, MS will automatically install code of its choice without letting you examine the download or cancel it!

quoteworthy

"The more choices you have in entertainment programming, the more time consumers will spend in front of a guide. Any [TV] guide company is in a central, powerful position. The same way companies like Yahoo! and AOL are crucially important to guide people on the Internet"

Josh Bernoff, analyst at Forrester Research

"It's funky to be a geek and MP3 allows you to be an outlaw without knowing anything about technology. With MP3 you can become an outlaw just by clicking on a button"

G. Fedorovsky, British leader has started a political party named MP3!

tomorrow'stechnology

Roll up for the floppy television

In the past decade, televisions have become bigger, wider, flatter and now they're becoming thinner. Advancements in the development of next generation plastics that are capable of emitting light are coming closer to commercial production than ever. These screens can be rolled up when not in use. It all began with the development of a special compound called p-phenylenevinylene, which is a type of plastic that can glow green-yellow when subjected to an electric charge. Further developments led to the creation of a polymer capable of emitting red and blue light. Laboratories like Britain's Cambridge Display Technologies (CDT), which is among the forerunners in developing this technology, say that these flexible television screens would be ready for commercial production by 2004-05. The primary hindrance has been in finding a substance thin and flexible enough to protect the sensitive components used in the creation of these 'floppy screens' but this is also nearing commercial viability. As this technology gets cheaper, we will see fabrications of ultra-portable floppy screens that can be used anywhere from large screen public billboards, to TV-watches to even display-capable clothing!

■ Microsoft to enhance Active Directory in Windows .Net Server ■ John Cocke (77), inventor of RISC chips dies ■ Intel planning portable audio-video player